

Digital Transformation Roadmapping: Planning Organizational Technology Evolution

Executive Summary

Digital transformation is a multi-year, multi-phase organizational change that requires systematic planning. Under Active Inference, digital transformation roadmapping is the process of designing the **sequence of transitions** that moves the organization from its current sociotechnical state to a desired future state. This module covers transformation frameworks, change management, technology roadmapping, and the challenge of maintaining organizational stability while undergoing fundamental change.

Learning Objectives

1. Apply **digital transformation frameworks** to plan organizational technology evolution
 2. Design **transformation roadmaps** that sequence changes for maximum learning and minimum disruption
 3. Understand **change management** as updating the organization's generative model
 4. Navigate **portfolio governance** for digital investments
 5. Balance **transformation ambition** with **organizational capacity for change**
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Key Concepts

1. Transformation Frameworks

Framework	Core Idea	Stages
Kotter's 8 Steps	Change as sequential process	Urgency → Coalition → Vision → Communication → Empowerment → Quick Wins → Consolidation → Anchor
McKinsey Three Horizons	Parallel investment timing	H1 (current business) + H2 (emerging) + H3 (options)
SAFe Digital Transformation	Agile at enterprise scale	Portfolio → Value Stream → Program → Team
Platform Thinking	Build on capabilities	Foundation → Platform → Products → Ecosystem

2. The Transformation Paradox

Case Study — GE Digital: GE invested \$4B+ in digital transformation, creating GE Digital to build an industrial IoT platform (Predix). The initiative struggled because GE tried to transform too fast, across too many dimensions simultaneously, without building organizational capability to absorb the change. The lesson: transformation requires matching the pace of change to the organization's capacity to learn. Too fast, and the organization fragments (high free energy). Too slow, and the competitive environment changes faster than the adaptation.

3. Change Management as Model Updating

Digital transformation requires updating not just technology but the organization's collective generative model:

- **Beliefs:** What the organization thinks is possible and valuable

- **Processes:** How work is done
- **Skills:** What people know how to do
- **Culture:** What behaviors are rewarded and expected
- **Identity:** How the organization sees itself

4. Sequencing Transformation

Principle	Application
Start with low-risk, high-visibility wins	Build credibility and learning before major investments
Build infrastructure before applications	Data platforms and integration before advanced analytics
Develop capability before scaling	Pilot programs before enterprise rollout
Learn continuously	Each phase generates learning that informs the next

Cross-References

- For organizational planning, see [Organizational Systems: Planning](#)
- For collective foresight, see [Collective Intelligence: Planning](#)
- For strategic risk, see [Strategic Modeling: Planning](#)

Summary

Concept	Digital Transformation Meaning
Transformation roadmap	Sequenced plan for organizational technology evolution
Change management	Updating the organization's collective generative model
Transformation paradox	Moving fast enough to be relevant but slow enough to learn
Portfolio governance	Managing the portfolio of digital investments across horizons
Sequencing	Ordering transformation activities for maximum learning and minimum disruption

References

- Kotter, J. P. (1996). *Leading Change*. Harvard Business Review Press.
- Rogers, D. L. (2016). *The Digital Transformation Playbook*. Columbia University Press.